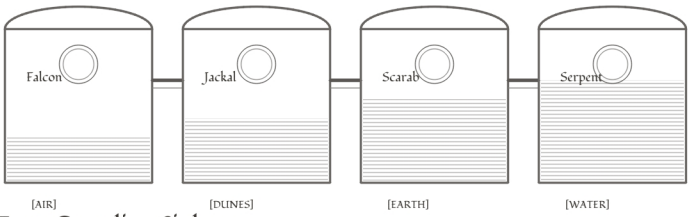
The Salt Playa & Vaults

Hydraulics of the Ancient Engineers · The Desert Oasis

I. The White Horizon

Emerging from the canyon fractures, the desert opens into an expanse of blinding white salt. The heat creates shimmering mirages of vast lakes, yet beneath the crystalline crust lies a marvel of ancient hydraulic engineering: four subterranean cisterns carved directly from bedrock and fed by deep artesian springs.



THE FOUR BALANCED CISTERNS OF THE OASIS CLEPSYDRA

II. The Four Guardian Siphons

Each cistern is guarded by an animal totem: Falcon, Jackal, Scarab, and Serpent. Balanced by lead siphon tubes, they hold fresh mineral water. But the siphons only flow when the four seekers, arrival hours, and relics are matched in perfect harmony upon Sheet 15B. Key XXX releases thirty measures of life-giving water.

III. Replenishing the Expedition

Before Hermes can cross the salt flats to the Sandstone Sanctuary, all four water vessels must be filled. Inspect the logic matrix on Sheet 15B: solve the seekers' puzzle and enter Key XXX into the Clepsydra dial.